Soham Karmarkar

EXTC

Company: Nomura

Job Profile: ITD

Offer Type: Internship + (Performance based PPO)

Internship Stipend: 75000

CTC: 11.6 + 2(Joining Bonus) LPA

Location: Powai, Mumbai

Process Date: OA : 31/07/2025, Interview : 01/08/2025

Placement Process:

1. Pre-placement Talk (Online)
2. Aptitude Test
3. Technical Interview 1
4. Technical Interview 2
5. HR Round

1. **Online Aptitude Test** [180+ students appeared]

This was an online aptitude test conducted on MeritTrac's Online Assessment Engine – PARIKSHA, The test consisted of 60 questions, divided equally into **Analytical, Quantitative, and Verbal** sections, with no negative marking. The total time was 60 minutes, so time management was crucial.

The level of difficulty was easy to medium, questions focused on topics like:

- Verbal - antonyms, prepositions, comprehensions, etc.
- Analytical - Statement & Implications, Graphs and Histograms followed by 4-5 Qs.
- Quants - Basic work & time, speeds, averages, profit & discounts,

I started with the verbal section quickly completing it in almost 10-12 minutes. For passages, go through the questions first then look for those keywords. Quants & Analytical was easy to medium level.

I felt like I had answered most of the questions correctly, except 2/3 which i couldn't come back to.

Time management is the key here, practice giving timed tests on indiabix/ some other platform.

We got the shortlist at around 7:00 p.m., and the interviews were scheduled at 9:00 a.m. on 1st August, so we hardly had any time to prepare.

I started by reviewing past interview experiences for potential questions and answers. I noticed that the concepts of OOPs and SQL were the most important, so I gave them the most weightage during my preparation. I revised all of my projects on the resume, the technologies implemented, and any possible questions on them. Apart from that, I revised all the essential concepts of Object-Oriented Programming, DSA, and DBMS. I ensured I was confident enough to answer all the questions and get at least 3 to 4 hours of sleep.

On the interview day, I reached college at around 8:30 a.m. The interview started at 9:15 a.m. At around 11:50 a.m., there was a strange incident — we were informed about some possible malpractice in the assessment test that had taken place the previous day. As a result, we were told that there would be another screening test for the shortlisted candidates.
This test was a pen-paper test and consisted of three questions — one each from DSA, aptitude, and SQL:

1. **Aptitude**: A tap can fill a tank in 10 hrs, B in 8 hrs, and C can empty it in 12 hrs. If all three are open, how long will it take to fill the tank?

2. **DSA**: Maximum Subarray Sum

3. **SQL**: Find the employee(s) with the highest salary under each manager.

I tried writing optimal answers, and wherever I was unsure, I explained my thinking behind the answer.
After this test, **7 candidates** were shortlisted from the **28**, and the interviews restarted.

2. Technical Interview I [28 candidates were shortlisted, later reduced to 7]

The interview:
After the test, we had gone to eat something, but I was immediately called for my first interview. It started around **1:10 p.m.**
As I walked in, the interviewer asked me a few questions to make me feel comfortable. Then I started with my introduction, where I also mentioned two of my notable projects, achievements, and the tech stack.
This led the questions to go straight to my projects first, which I was well-prepared for. I briefly explained the projects and the reason for using the specific tech stacks as well.
Next, I was asked about the pen-paper test — my approach to solving it, and the time and space complexities involved.
Then, the topic moved on to **sorting algorithms** and their complexities. When I mentioned **O(n log n)** for merge sort, I was asked in which cases the **log n** complexity is achieved.
There was also some discussion about **HashMaps vs Sets**. I was asked about the toughest and easiest Leetcode problems I've come across.

Next, discussion shifted to one of my projects, where there was some hardware implementation too. I was asked follow-up questions about the stack used (**FastAPI and MySQL**) — which **HTTP verbs** were used where, etc.
I was also tested on **OOPs concepts — overriding vs overloading**, **garbage collection** (which I couldn't really answer in depth), and **C++ vs Java** since I've used C++.

A basic puzzle was also asked:
Given 5, 5, 5, 5, 5 — get the answer = 125.

DBMS concepts were also asked — like **indexing** and why insertion and updation become slower in an indexed database. We also discussed **SQL vs NoSQL**.
No HR questions were asked.

The interview went on for around **35–40 minutes**.

3. Technical Interview II [7 candidates were selected out of 28]

I was called for Round 2 about **35–40 minutes** after Round 1. There were **2 interviewers** this time.
Overall, Round 2 was a bit more challenging, as there were many follow-ups on every answer, leading to in-depth discussions.

The interview started with my introduction again. The interviewers were very rigorous about my **resume** — every project was discussed in detail, including follow-ups regarding the **technologies used** and **how they were implemented**. My **contribution** to each project was asked.

After the resume discussion, I was asked several questions related to **DBMS**. I was given a sample table and asked to perform operations — it was a **joins** question. I began explaining my approach but was asked to just write the query directly.

I was asked about **normalization and denormalization**, and had to explain all the forms with an example DB / real-life example.
This included related topics like **partial dependencies**, etc.

OOPs was also asked — I was asked to name the **four pillars**, explain each with a real-life example, followed by a code explanation. Then I was asked about the use of the **super** keyword, and questions regarding **abstract classes vs interfaces**, when to use which, etc.

This interview went on for more than **40 minutes** since there was a lot of explanation involved, followed by writing **code/queries**.

At the end, I was asked what I do apart from studying, and why I am switching from **EXTC to an IT-related role**.
My question to them was about their **first experience in a corporate setup** and how they adapted to the changes. One of the interviewers was very senior and couldn't recall his first experience, so I switched the question to his first **experience at Nomura**.
The overall experience was very good — I never felt grilled or intimidated.

4. HR Round [3 candidates were selected out of 7]

The HR round was just a short formality since it was already around **4:30 p.m.**
The HR mentioned she too had a long day and wanted to wrap it up quickly.

I was asked about **where I stay**, **travel time**, **family background**, and **future plans**.
My follow-up question was about the **employee volunteering programs** she mentioned during the PPT.

3 students were selected for the ITD role.

Useful Tips:

1. Be honest — **don't fake your resume.** They do read every line and can grill you on it. Only mention skills and projects you truly know. If at all you've added something extra, be as thorough with it as your other projects.

2. Be **fundamentally strong** — all your concepts regarding **OOPs** and **DBMS** need to be clear, as direct and indirect questions are asked on these topics.

3. For **DSA**, focus on **NeetCode roadmap / Striver sheet**. Make sure to revise the implementations of **maps, stacks, lists, queues**, etc.

4. **Aptitude** needs some practice to get used to all patterns. After that, it's all about how focused you are on the day.

5. Never directly say you **don't know** a topic — try explaining it as much as you can, and then say you can't recall the details.

6. Prepare your **intro** such that it steers the questions toward topics of your strength. Always mention **keywords** you're well-versed with since these can be follow-ups.

7. Maintain a **positive approach** and greet them with a smile.

8. **LUCK** plays quite a role in on-campus placements, so don't be disheartened if you're not shortlisted. After about **7–8 assessments**, this was my first interview opportunity.

Material:

- **OOPs**: Kunal Kushwaha Playlist

- **SQL**: SQL Bolt, https://www.sql-practice.com/

- Use **GPT** for generating possible questions on your resume — be sure you can answer each resume-related question. Also, prepare for **EXTC-based questions** if you're from the branch.

- **Apti**: IndiaBix — more than enough.

Feel free to contact if you have any doubts:

📞 Soham Karmarkar : 8369036486
🔗 LinkedIn